



The real T- Rex

New species of dinosaur roughly 100 million years old might shed more light on the T-Rex. <http://dgit.in/RealRex>



Verily's new smartwatch

Alphabet's Life Sciences division, Verily is showing off their all-new health-focused 'Verily Study Watch' on their blog. <http://dgit.in/VerilyStudy>

manufacturer, then the keyboard will register every single key on the keyboard simultaneously. To avoid confusion, we'll be referring to it as full N-key rollover. This is an important feature for games that will require multiple simultaneous key presses. You should be fine with 6 or 10-key rollover in most of the games. Earlier, full N-key rollover was limited to only PS/2 connectors while USB ports supported a maximum of 6-key rollover (including six alphabet keys and the four modifier keys). This is not the case anymore. We are yet to arrive at a situation where we actually needed more than 6-key rollover in our daily gaming and typing routine, hence this was chosen as a minimum.

In certain game genres such as MOBAs, extra keys with macro capability to assign abilities and item buys make a huge difference in competitive gameplay. Mapping the entire process of buying a particular item to a single key is also favoured. In FPS games, binds can also be assigned to a single key to save the pain of conventionally going through two or more steps. Not really an essential feature, but it's always great to have.

Most of the keyboards, even generic ones have anti-ghosting capabilities nowadays, and we've rarely come across this error in high-end keyboards.

Referred to as "Game Mode" by some, the toggle switch to disable the Windows key(s) is a welcome feature. Gamers hate unwanted Windows key triggers with a passion that they don't even reserve for game bosses.

We are currently in an age where even mousepads have RGB lighting. Whether RGB or non-RGB, backlighting on a gaming keyboard is important because you'll be gaming in a dark environment most of the time (if you're like us). The brightness level is also important and having different levels (turning it off as well) is a welcome feature. Lighting modes are simply a gimmick and offer no functional advantage, just aesthetics. RGB lighting can be useful if your PC build follows a certain colour scheme and you want your keyboard to match that. Functionally, you might imagine assigning different colours to different keys for games can be useful, but most of the time you wouldn't be even looking down at your keyboard.

Certain gaming keyboards ship extra interchangeable keycaps for WASD and 1234 keys. These are essentially for FPS games and you will also find interchangeable keycaps for QWERTF for MOBAs. They are either coloured, textured or both, where the textured option is always better.

The ability to reprogram and reassign key functions using a software is great for productivity and gaming. The software bundled with a keyboard includes these features with more customisations. You can record complex macros, remap key functions, tweak the backlight, etc., and all of these settings can be saved to the keyboard (if supported by hardware) in different profiles. Although it isn't an important feature, few keyboards include some functions such as recording macros, changing the back-

lighting, switching polling rates, etc., right on the keyboard without any software.

Additional features such as USB passthrough ports, audio ports, mouse cable holders, detachable cables, and grooves for cable management are useful but more of a luxury. In summary, here are the essential features for a gaming keyboard:

- Mechanical switch
- 6-key rollover or more
- 100% anti-ghosting
- Backlight support

Any keyboard that fulfilled the above criteria was considered a gaming keyboard and included in this comparison test.

THE COMPETITION

Cooler Master MasterKeys Pro S White LEDs

After having used 15-20 different mechanical keyboards, we can say that their brightness levels have been almost the same. A white backplate on the bottom, as seen on the Corsair STRAFE RGB and Razer BlackWidow Chroma

it by two. Being a tenkeyless variant, it had the smallest footprint or volume, even compared to the tenkeyless Corsair K63. This makes it the most portable keyboard from the bunch. Although it has an included carrying pouch, we would have appreciated if it was of a greater quality compared to the ones we see in the HyperX Alloy FPS or Gigabyte XK700. Sadly, there's no software support for the keyboard but that doesn't restrict the necessary features expected on a gaming keyboard. Several functions on the keyboard can be used with modifier keys including macro recording, setting up profiles and shifting between lighting modes. The same level of customisation isn't possible on other keyboards without software support. At this price, you get all the advantages of portability, customisation and also genuine Cherry MX Blue switches packed inside. A detachable cable only makes the keyboard more portable friendly.



Cooler Master MasterKeys Pro S White LEDs

V1, made them look brighter and vibrant. However, the LEDs on the MasterKeys Pro S White LED variant is miles ahead. The brightness on this keyboard was so high that we had to keep it on one lower step than the brightest level while in a well lit room but in a dark room, we lowered

Corsair K63

The Corsair K63 is the only other tenkeyless variant in this comparison. Speaking of the footprint, the K63 is a little broader because of the dedicated multimedia, brightness level and Windows lock keys. You do get software support but in order to save all the